PROJECT MILESTONES - 24 months, 1 March 2027 to 28 February 2029

Fungal and microbial colonisation of tropical educational building exteriors: molecular characterisation and campus air-quality context at UTS Sibu
Dr Armstrong Ighodalo Omoregie | BERI, School of Built Environment, UTS | UTS Matching Grant, Cycle 1/2027

Preparatory — before 1 Mar 2027

- SORAS application for SBC Permit variation and renewal submitted
- MoA Clause 21 addendum executed: title, Commencement Date and term, Schedule A A5 team, Schedule B Part 1 budget
- SRDC-TROPI written confirmation of matched expenditure re-issued against revised dates
- Consumable supply split confirmed with SRDC-TROPI; supplier quotations refreshed
- No sampling, biological transfer or expenditure before the Commencement Date (MoA Clause 5.2)

Phase 1 — Mar - May 2027

- Four buildings stratified by facade material, age, design approach and exposure
- 36 fixed sampling points established, georeferenced and photographed
- Facade material and shading inventory complete
- Monitoring hardware procured; node fabrication begun
- Sampling, culture and contamination-control protocols agreed with SRDC-TROPI and validated

Phase 2 — Apr 2027 - Jul 2028

- R1 Apr 2027, R2 Jul 2027, R3 Oct 2027, R4 Jan 2028, R5 Apr 2028, R6 Jul 2028
- Haze-triggered supplementary rounds as episodes arise
- Nodes calibrated against rented reference instrument and installed; dashboard and display live by Sep 2027
- Algal and cyanobacterial cover plus microclimate covariates recorded at every point, every round
- Field, transport and extraction blanks collected each round

Phase 3 — Apr 2027 - Oct 2028

- Rolling cold-chain transfer of inoculated plates to SRDC-TROPI, one round at a time
- Incubation, CFU enumeration, morphotyping, isolation and purification at SRDC-TROPI
- Interim community profile at twelve months (Apr 2028)
- DNA extraction and ITS PCR; Sanger identification of the curated 100-isolate set
- Blanks processed and reported alongside each batch; isolate collection curated

Phase 4 — Aug 2028 - Feb 2029

- Full seasonal and year-on-year statistical and community analysis
- First indexed manuscript submitted (Oct 2028)
- Exterior material selection and maintenance guidance issued
- Campus air-quality reporting protocol issued; sequences deposited with accessions
- Second indexed manuscript submitted (Jan 2029)
- Final project report and grant closure via URCMS by 28 Feb 2029

Fixed 24-month term, no extension. Sampling closes Jul 2028 and molecular work Oct 2028 so that the final four months carry only analysis, writing, dissemination and closure. No deliverable depends on activity after Oct 2028 other than writing.